

DESIGN CODE NS 12

BOBBLE

Christmas Tree

BLACK + WHITE · WHITE BACKGROUNDS · PROGRESS BOXES

US + UK TERMS · EASY-INTERMEDIATE · 2-3 HOURS · ABOUT 12 CM

WORSTED · 4.0 MM HOOK

NAMED ORIGINAL COLOURWAY

FIR GREEN · CRIMSON · GOLD · CREAM

ABOUT THIS COMPANION FILE

Designed for economical home printing and progress tracking.

Large artwork is omitted; the written directions match the full-colour edition.

Pattern profile

NS 12 is the permanent identity of this pattern. Keep it with every revision, tester note, photograph and support message.

FORMAT US + UK TERMS	SKILL LEVEL EASY-INTERMEDIATE	ACTIVE TIME 2-3 HOURS	FINISHED SIZE ABOUT 12 CM
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Named original colourway

FIR GREEN one-piece tree · about 60-80 g	CRIMSON optional contrast bobbles	GOLD optional contrast bobbles	CREAM optional contrast bobbles
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Use the written colour names and material roles when selecting yarn; screen and printer appearance varies.

Progress tracking

Every construction-table row begins with a printable [] box. Tick it only after completing the row and confirming the stated count.

Read before making

Read every component and finishing note before beginning. Mark completed rows, confirm the count at each row end, and stop immediately if your count differs. Complete internal eyes, embroidery, knots and joins while the relevant opening remains accessible.

Safety: this PDF does not claim that a finished item meets any toy or consumer-product standard. Follow the full Safety section and obtain every assessment required for the finished item's intended market and use.

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Contents

Major sections are listed below; all component headings are bookmarked. Table headers repeat after page breaks, and the design code appears on every page.

Safety — read this first	4
Materials	4
Gauge & size	4
Abbreviations (US + UK)	4
Construction & techniques	5
Instructions	5
Finishing & assembly	6
Troubleshooting	7
Colourways	7
Helpful tips	7
Care	7
Terms of Use	7

How to use this pattern

Read the complete component before beginning it. Move the marker at the start of every crochet round unless the master says otherwise. Diagrams and illustrations support orientation only; the numbered written directions control construction.

US + UK terms · Easy - Intermediate · 2 - 3 hours — Design Code NS 12

A soft standing fir built in one piece: plain rounds, then tier after tier of bobbles that thin out toward the tip. Contrast-colour bobbles turn it into baubles-on-a-tree in a single round.

FINISHED SIZE About 12 cm (4.7 in) tall and 7 cm (2.8 in) wide in worsted / aran on a 4 mm hook. About 15-16 cm tall in chunky yarn on a 5 mm hook. One piece; a felt or cardboard base disc is optional.

Safety — read this first

As written, the contrast-colour bobbles are crocheted into the fabric and the design has no beads or glued decorations. Adding beads, bells or other embellishments can create detachable small parts; do not add them without reassessing the finished item. Stuff firmly and secure every yarn end.

No finished tree has been shown by Novality Crochet Studio to comply with ASTM F963, EN 71 or another toy-safety regime. Omitting embellishments removes those component hazards but does not establish age suitability or product compliance. Before supply, the finished-item maker or seller must determine all applicable classification, assessment, testing, documentation, labelling and traceability duties in every destination market.

Materials

- Main yarn: worsted / aran (#4) in green, 60-80 g.
- Contrast (optional): small amounts of red, gold, cream for contrast bobbles.
- Hook: 4 mm (US G-6); use 3 mm for DK mini, 5 mm for chunky.
- Stuffing: fibre fill about 25 g (a little only - the tree stands on tension).
- Optional: 1 circle of cardboard or firm felt for the base. Trace inside the R9 fold ridge and cut the circle 3-5 mm smaller; at the stated gauge it will usually be 55-65 mm across.
- Notions: stitch marker, tapestry needle, scissors.

Gauge & size

Aim for a firm fabric (~10-11 sc x 11 rounds = 5 cm). Exact size is not critical; droopy bobbles mean too much stuffing - the shell should hold its cone almost on its own.

Abbreviations (US + UK)

MR - magic ring · BLO - back loop only

ch - chain · BO - 5-dc bobble (counts as 1 st) / UK: 5-tr bobble (counts as 1 st)

sl st - slip stitch · FO - fasten off

sc = dc - single crochet / double crochet · st(s) - stitch(es)

inc - increase (2 sc in one st) / UK: increase (2 dc in one st) · R - round

sc2tog = dc2tog - work 2 stitches together as one (a decrease) · (n) - stitch count at round end

How to read this dual pattern: every round appears twice side by side - the US-terms instruction in the left column, the exact UK equivalent in the right column. Stitch counts are identical for both terminologies. Prose tips use US terms.

Construction & techniques

Worked in continuous rounds from the base up - no joins, no starting chains. The BLO round (R9) turns the flat base upward into the cone wall. Bobble rounds alternate with plain rounds; every bobble round from R12 onward hides one sc2tog per repeat, so the cone tapers evenly and the bobbles stay in regular columns.

1. The magic ring - Work 6 sc into a ring and pull the tail tight.
2. Back loop only (BLO) - Work into the far loop only. The unused front loops form a ridge that makes the base fold neatly under the tree.
3. The 5-dc bobble - Yarn over, insert hook, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through 2 loops (incomplete dc). Repeat 4 more times in the same stitch - 6 loops on hook - then yarn over and pull through all 6. Counts as ONE stitch.
4. Contrast bobbles - The bobble itself must be worked in the contrast colour. Complete the final pull-through of the stitch BEFORE a bobble with contrast yarn (for the first bobble of a round, change on the last stitch of the preceding round). Work all five incomplete dc in contrast, then use green for the final yarn-over and pull it through all 6 loops. Continue the next stitch in green, carrying the unused colour loosely inside. Do not work a green bobble and change only its closing loop - that makes a green bobble with a contrast-colour top, not a contrast bobble.
5. sc2tog decrease - One decrease per repeat sits in the last position of each shaping repeat, so the bobble columns stay aligned. An invisible decrease through the front loops of the next two stitches may replace sc2tog without changing the count.
6. Close R22 spacing - [B0, sc2tog] is intentionally compact: the bobble uses one old stitch and the following decrease uses the next two. Complete the bobble with relaxed loops, push it to the right side immediately, then work the decrease without yanking its working loop against the bobble. The low decrease anchors the bobble and R23's plain round settles the narrowed fabric; do not insert an extra anchor stitch.

Instructions

1. Tree - one piece, green (contrast optional)

The cone tapers between bobble tiers; the plain round between them keeps each tier distinct. If using a rigid base disc, insert it immediately after Rnd 9 while the opening still has 48 stitches. Begin adding small amounts of stuffing after Rnd 14 and continue every 2-3 rounds - do not wait until the six-stitch tip.

Rnd	US terms	UK terms	Sts	Note
[] R1	6 sc in MR	6 dc in MR	(6)	-
[] R2	inc in each st around	inc in each st around	(12)	-
[] R3	[sc, inc] x 6	[dc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
[] R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	[2 dc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
[] R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	[3 dc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
[] R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	[4 dc, inc] x 6	(36)	-
[] R7	[5 sc, inc] x 6	[5 dc, inc] x 6	(42)	-
[] R8	[6 sc, inc] x 6	[6 dc, inc] x 6	(48)	base = full width
[] R9	BLO: sc in each st around	BLO: dc in each st around	(48)	base fold ridge; insert optional disc now
[] R10	[B0, 7 sc] x 6	[B0, 7 dc] x 6	(48)	first bobble tier
[] R11	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(48)	-

Rnd	US terms	UK terms	Sts	Note
[] R12	[BO, 5 sc, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, 5 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(42)	-
[] R13	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(42)	-
[] R14	[BO, 4 sc, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, 4 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(36)	begin light, progressive stuffing
[] R15	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(36)	-
[] R16	[BO, 3 sc, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, 3 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(30)	-
[] R17	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(30)	-
[] R18	[BO, 2 sc, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, 2 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(24)	-
[] R19	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(24)	-
[] R20	[BO, sc, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, dc, dc2tog] x 6	(18)	-
[] R21	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(18)	-
[] R22	[BO, sc2tog] x 6	[BO, dc2tog] x 6	(12)	18 to 12; push each BO outward before the adjacent decrease
[] R23	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(12)	-
[] R24	sc2tog x 6	dc2tog x 6	(6)	final small pinch of stuffing before this round
[] R25	sc in each st around	dc in each st around	(6)	-
[] R26	sc2tog x 3	dc2tog x 3	(3)	tip

R22 count and shape check: each repeat consumes 1 stitch for the BO plus 2 stitches for sc2tog and produces 1 BO plus 1 decrease: 3 consumed and 2 produced. Six repeats therefore use all 18 stitches and leave 12. Work one repeat, confirm the bobble remains on the right side, then continue; after the complete round, use the still-open tip to nudge all six bobbles outward before R23.

If the selected yarn still forces these six close-set bobbles inward after tension adjustment, undo R22 and use the count-preserving smooth-tip fallback [sc, sc2tog] x 6 (12) / UK [dc, dc2tog] x 6 (12). This intentionally omits the final bobble tier but keeps the 18 → 12 shaping. Record which version the sample uses; do not add an uncounted anchor stitch.

Finish: FO with a tail, thread through the last 3 stitches, pull the tip closed and weave the end down through the tree.

Stuffing: only the bottom half needs real fill - a lightly stuffed cone that flexes is nicer than a rigid one. After Rnd 9, trace just inside the fold ridge, cut the optional felt or cardboard disc 3-5 mm smaller than that outline (usually 55-65 mm at the stated gauge), and place it against the inside of the base; it will not pass through the narrowed tip later. Cardboard makes the tree non-washable. Add stuffing progressively from Rnd 14 and keep the upper cone light.

Finishing & assembly

- Contrast bobbles: change TO contrast before each bobble, work its five incomplete dc in contrast, then change BACK to green on the bobble's closing pull-through. One or two contrast tiers look best.
- Base: for a shelf decoration, place the optional disc after Rnd 9, keep it flat against the base while you work, and stuff around it gradually.
- Hanging: join any colour at the tip, ch 18, sl st into the same place.
- Set of three: DK + 3 mm hook, worsted + 4 mm hook, chunky + 5 mm hook - counts are identical, sizes stair-step from about 9 cm to 16 cm.

Troubleshooting

- Bobble columns wander. Your round start drifted with the spiral - a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round keeps the repeat anchored. A little lag looks natural: real fir boughs point downhill too.
- R22 bobbles cave inward. Undo the affected repeat, remake the BO with relaxed loops, push it outward before the decrease and avoid tightening the decrease against it. If the actual yarn still will not hold the six close-set bobbles, use the documented smooth-tip R22 fallback rather than adding stitches.
- Tip flops. Over-stuffed at the top. Take two pinches of stuffing out of the cone tip and re-cinch R26 tightly.
- Base will not sit flat. You skipped the BLO ridge (R9) or worked it loosely. That ridge is the fold - re-press it with a fingernail while shaping.

Colourways

FIR GREEN one-piece tree · about 60-80 g	CRIMSON optional contrast bobbles	GOLD optional contrast bobbles	CREAM optional contrast bobbles
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NAMED ORIGINAL COLOURWAY · FIR GREEN · CRIMSON · GOLD · CREAM.

Colourway notes: Fir green · Sage velvet · Snow white · Crimson berry · Gold-tipped

Helpful tips

- Why every bobble tier shrinks by 6: each [BO, k sc, sc2tog] repeat works one hidden decrease, at the END of the repeat, so the bobbles never drift out of their columns even while the cone narrows 10 rounds in a row. R22 is the extreme case: [BO, sc2tog] uses 3 sts and makes 2 per repeat - 18 sts used, 12 left, nothing unworked.

Care

Follow the labels for every yarn and insert used. A tree containing cardboard is not washable; keep it dry and surface clean only. Before publishing any other care claim or supplying finished trees, clean and dry a complete sample made with the exact proposed insert and yarn, then inspect for dye transfer, distortion, stuffing migration, bobble damage and a warped base. Until that sample test passes, recommend gentle surface cleaning with a damp cloth and drying upright away from heat.

Terms of Use

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Finish checklist & notes

- [] R9 base ridge and optional disc fit checked
- [] Every round count confirmed before narrowing
- [] Contrast bobbles use contrast for all five partial dc
- [] R22 version recorded: six bobbles or smooth-tip fallback
- [] Stuffing stays light at tip; R26 closes at 3 stitches
- [] Base, tip, loop and all yarn ends inspected

PROJECT NOTES

[illegible]